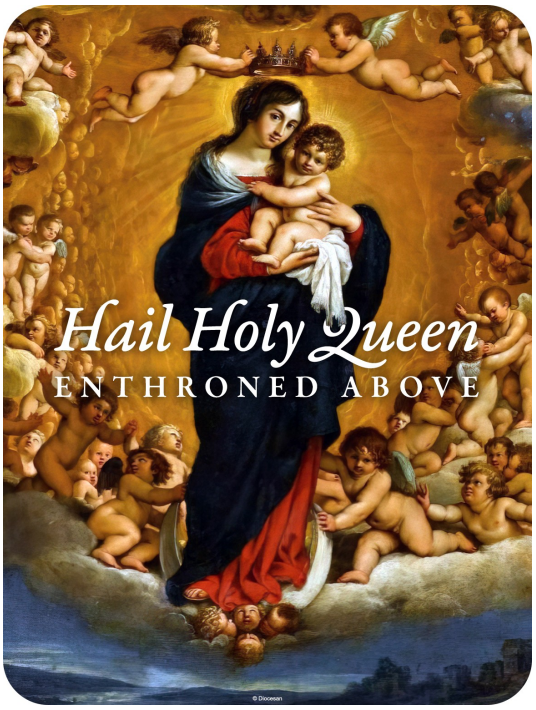
Mid-Summer Greetings From Your Pastor, Fr. Craig Lusk



I hope and pray that everyone is having a great summer! I certainly have been enjoying my time away to recreate and enjoy the good things in Michigan, which for me is being up at Higgins Lake. I give thanks to Almighty God for being able to have a small cottage in the woods a short distance from one of Michigan's finest inland lakes.

Our parishioner, Ann Miller, gave me a book a few months ago entitled, "A Grand Slam for God (A journey from baseball star to Catholic Priest)." This is the biography of Fr. Burke Masters, Diocese of Joliet, IL, and it is a beautiful and moving profile of his conversion to Catholicism and priestly life (like myself!). I highly recommend anyone to consider this great testimonial to the beauty and teachings our precious Catholic faith.

A quote from the last chapter of Fr. Burke's book:
"Our life is not defined by one single moment or by one generous act. Life is not one grand slam, surrounded by a bunch of forgettable moments. Every moment that we are given is an opportunity for a grand slam for God. If you offer your life, your gifts, your talents, and your time to him, there is no telling what your story will be."

I finished this book in one week when I was just up North. This was a great prelude to our Collaborative event on the Assumption of our Blessed Mother in Heaven, Friday August 15. I am calling all parishioners of St. John & St. Mary to reap the spiritual benefits of participating in an awesome day in the life of the Church! St. Mary has been named a Jubilee site for the Jubilee Year 2025. Bishop Edward Lohse will be with us for the closing Mass at 4pm followed by a great dinner, social and opportunity to purchase religious goods from the Holy Land. Adoration, Confession and prayer are all part of this spiritual oasis of our spiritual faith walk with the Lord. Will you please join us in this beautiful opportunity to become closer to Jesus?

In His love,
Fr. Craig

Holy Land Carvings Group Visiting St. Mary on August 15



We are the Holy Land Carvings group, and we are proud to represent the Christian woodcarvers of Bethlehem. These artisans rely on tourism, but due to the war in Israel, they have lost their jobs and are unable to provide for their families.

Our goal is to sell beautiful hand-carved Olive Wood religious items, including Nativity Scenes, Crucifixes, Rosaries, Statues, Pictures of the Last Supper, and many other religious items, to Catholic Churches in the United States. By purchasing one of these exquisite items, you will be supporting the Christian families in the Holy Land and helping them provide for their families and maintain their jobs.

We invite you to take a moment to browse through the carvings that will be available on **Friday, August 15 at St. Mary (School Building Classroom) from 3-6pm**. By supporting this project, you are making a significant contribution towards keeping the Christian community present in the Holy Land. Please join us in this worthy cause and help us make a difference. We deeply appreciate your support!

Holy Land Carvings, (810) 247-3903, Shop Online: www.holylandcarvings.com